YourDOST: company brief for the interview

History, numbers, STP, pricing, marketing, distribution, experts and hiring, bottlenecks, and competitors in India and abroad, plus how to pitch yourself. V marks verified (filings or news); S marks self-reported by YourDOST or an estimate. Say "self-reported" when you quote an S number.

1. Snapshot

What	India's online emotional wellness and mental-health platform: anonymous chat, call and video with psychologists, counsellors, coaches and psychiatrists; plus EAP and student wellness programs, workshops and assessments.
Legal entity	Yourdost Health Solutions Pvt Ltd, CIN U85100**MP2015**PTC034410, so incorporated in Madhya Pradesh in 2015 V. Operates from Bengaluru.
Founded	Late (December) 2014 by **Richa Singh**, **Puneet Manuja**, **Prakhar Verma** and **Satyajeet Nandekar** V
Revenue	**₹19.9 Cr FY25**, up 2.5% from ₹19.5 Cr in FY24; FY25 net profit about **₹33.6 lakh**, no debt (MCA filings via Tracxn and Inc42) V
Funding	About **US$1.7M** total over 3 small rounds; seed/pre-Series A led by **SAIF Partners (now Elevation Capital)** in June 2016; last round about $126K in Feb 2018 V. A capital-efficient company.
Scale	**30 lakh+** one-on-one sessions, **500+** organisations, 23+ states, **20+** Indian languages, 24/7, "an expert in 30 seconds", **1,000+** experts; claims 10,000–12,000+ lives saved S
Team	About 270–300 employees (PitchBook 272, Latka 297) S

2. Origin story (tell it in 20 seconds)

At **IIT Guwahati**, a hostel-mate of Richa Singh died by suicide over placement stress. Counsellors existed on campus, but almost nobody used them because of stigma. Richa, an IIT Guwahati graduate who later went to IIM Bangalore, teamed up with **Puneet Manuja** (IIM Bangalore gold medallist, who had faced placement stress himself) and **Prakhar Verma** (computer science, BMSCE Bangalore). Satyajeet Nandekar is the fourth co-founder. Their idea: make it as easy and stigma-free to talk to an expert as to a friend, a "dost". Hence the name and the anonymous, online-first model. (Founders' interviews: YourStory 2015, Feminism in India 2016. Leadership titles vary by source: CB Insights lists Richa as CEO, Latka lists Puneet.)

3. Timeline: 10 years, 5 years, 3 years

When	What happened
Dec 2014	Founded in Bengaluru; online anonymous counselling with a freemium model (free text chat; early paid calls about ₹400 voice / ₹600 video) S
2015	Company incorporated (Yourdost Health Solutions Pvt Ltd); early press: "Breaking the stigma" (YourStory)
Jun 2016	Raised over $1.2M from angels and a pre-Series A from **SAIF Partners** (now Elevation). Angels include **Phanindra Sama** (redBus), **Aprameya Radhakrishna** (TaxiForSure), LetsVenture, NuVentures, Subba Rao Telidevara. Funds used to hire senior leadership and expand
Feb 2018	Last disclosed round (about $126K); total about $1.7M

FY18 → FY23	Revenue ₹2.28 → ₹19.7 Cr: the B2B shift (corporates, colleges, government) drives growth
2020–21 (COVID)	Demand surge; a free counselling helpline with Haryana's Department of Higher Education; work with NSDC and government student projects. Aug 2021: **15 lakh+ sessions, 300 institutional clients, 900 experts** (YourStory)
2024 (10 years)	"A Decade of Wellness": 30 lakh individuals, about 10,000 lives saved in 9 years S. Session mix: **57.88% chat, 18.49% audio, 17.8% video, 5.84% in-person**. Emotional Wellbeing of Entrepreneurs study with INK, TiE, Upekkha and NSRCEL
FY24–FY25	Revenue flat at ₹19.5 → ₹19.9 Cr, but profitable (₹33.6 L) with no debt. Campus deals continue (IIT Guwahati 24/7 support, GITAM, IILM); the Founders Program runs with Upekkha and NSRCEL (250+ founders)

Revenue history (₹ Cr, MCA filings via Tracxn)

FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
2.28	2.98	6.64	9.78	14.6	19.7	19.5	19.9

- **Last 10 years:** from a stigma-busting consumer chat app to a B2B-led wellness provider for 500+ institutions.
- **Last 5 years (FY20 → FY25):** ₹6.64 → ₹19.9 Cr, which is 3× (about 25% CAGR), helped by COVID and EAP adoption.
- **Last 3 years (FY23 → FY25):** plateau at about ₹19.5–19.9 Cr (about 0.5% a year), but profitable. **This plateau is the most important business fact to know.** It's why new segments and products, like the Founders Program, matter.

4. STP: segmentation, targeting, positioning

Segments

Segment	Who pays / who uses	Offer
Corporates (EAP)	HR, CHRO and benefits teams pay; employees and families use	24/7 confidential counselling, webinars and workshops, wellbeing campaigns, manager training, assessments; best fit for mid-to-large firms and startups
Colleges and universities	Deans and the institution pay; students use	24/7 student wellness: IIT Guwahati, GITAM, IILM, IISc Wellness Centre, Indian Institute of Astrophysics, Regional Centre for Biotechnology
Government	Departments and skill bodies	Helplines (Haryana DHE during COVID), NSDC, programs for low-income students
Startups and founders	The founder pays; incubators and VCs refer	Founders Program: ₹6,000 / ₹9,600 / ₹12,000 for 4 / 8 / 12 weeks; Upekkha, NSRCEL
Individuals (B2C)	Self-pay	Pay-per-session chat, call or video; about ₹1,299–1,599 a session today S

Targeting

B2B2C is the core: institutions pay and individuals use. Institutional clients make up most of revenue (company statements). The B2C funnel feeds awareness and trust. The sweet spot is **young urban Indians, 18–35**: students under exam and placement stress, and early-career professionals with work stress, relationships and loneliness.

Positioning

> "Your emotional wellness coach": a friend (dost) who is also an expert. Anonymous, stigma-free, affordable, in your language, available in 30 seconds, 24/7, on chat, call or video. It is framed as **wellness** (stress, relationships, career), not illness, which lowers stigma, with clinical escalation (psychiatrists) when needed.

Points of difference: earliest mover (2014) and scale (30 lakh sessions); chat-first (58% of sessions); 20+ languages; a deep institutional book (500+ organisations); profitable and lean. **Versus Amaha:** Amaha moved toward clinical care and hospitals; YourDOST stays an accessible, wellness-led, B2B-heavy platform.

5. Pricing

Product	Price	Note
B2C session (40–50 min)	About ₹1,299–1,599 S	Earlier freemium: free chat, ₹400 voice / ₹600 video (2016-era)
Founders Program	₹6,000 (4 wk, 4 calls) · ₹9,600 (8 wk, 6 calls) · ₹12,000 (12 wk, 8 calls), incl. GST	Published on the Founders page; about ₹1,500 a call
Corporate EAP / campus	Not public: annual contracts per employee or student, or per-session packages	Indian EAP pricing is typically tens of rupees per employee per month (my deck assumed ₹75 PEPM for team wellness). Call this an estimate

How to evaluate the pricing: B2C sits at mid-market therapy rates (therapists ₹1,000–3,000) and is far below executive coaching (₹20,000+). Bundles (weekly plans) raise commitment and completion. The B2B per-head model gives predictable revenue, but utilisation must be driven, or renewals suffer.

6. Marketing and distribution

- **Distribution:** (1) direct institutional sales to HR, CHROs, deans and government departments; (2) partners: incubators and accelerators (Upekkha, NSRCEL), campuses; (3) direct-to-consumer through the website and app (yourdost.com), chat-first; (4) on-site and face-to-face counsellors at corporate locations.
- **Marketing:** Instagram and LinkedIn content (carousels, myth-busters, Decade of Wellness data), webinars and wellbeing campaigns for clients' employees, PR and founder storytelling, SEO blog and self-assessments, events such as "The Festival of Happiness" (yourdost.net), and research reports (the founder wellbeing study) that double as B2B lead generation.
- **Growth loop:** client employees and students experience it → word of mouth → B2C users → more institutions.

7. Experts: who they are, how they hire

- **Who:** 1,000+ psychologists, counsellors, psychotherapists, career and life coaches, and psychiatrists for escalation (2021: 900 experts).
- **Hiring bar:** minimum Masters in Psychology, 3+ years of counselling experience, English plus Hindi or regional languages; some roles are face-to-face at corporate sites, with travel. Applications go to experthiring@yourdost.com.
- **Model:** a mix of full-time in-house counsellors (shifts, including nights for 24/7 cover) and empanelled freelance experts paid per session.
- **Pay (reported):** about ₹26k a month (psychologist) and ₹35k (senior) on Indeed; job ad range ₹31k–₹1.35L a month. Glassdoor compensation rating 2.8/5; about 60% would recommend.
- **What staff say:** praised for flexible, approachable management and as a good start for freshers; criticised for low pay, heavy workload, night shifts and attrition.

8. Bottlenecks they face (say these carefully, as opportunities)

Bottleneck	Evidence	What I'd do (EIR angle)
1. Growth plateau	₹19.7 → 19.5 → 19.9 Cr (FY23–25)	New segments and products: the Founders Program, team wellness for portfolio startups, parents (my Q1), upselling to the existing 500+ institutions
2. Low capital vs rivals	About $1.7M raised vs Amaha's ₹100 Cr round	Stay profitable; partner-led, low-CAC distribution (like the founder-pays model)
3. EAP utilisation and renewals	Stigma: only 15.1% seek help (Merak Ventures); HR wants proof of ROI	Content that lowers barriers (my Q2 "awkward questions" carousel), anonymous dashboards, outcome measurement (WHO-5)
4. Expert supply and quality	Low pay, attrition, night shifts (reviews)	Better utilisation means better per-expert earnings; specialisation tracks (founders, students); supervision and quality scores
5. B2C willingness to pay	Free alternatives: Tele MANAS 14416 (government), AI chatbots	Use B2C as the funnel; bundles; AI triage plus a human expert as the premium
6. Competition and AI	Amaha (clinical), Wysa (AI), global EAPs (Optum); generic AI assistants	Own the "trusted human expert in your language, 24/7" position; use AI for intake and matching
7. Compliance	Mental Healthcare Act 2017, DPDP Act 2023 (data privacy), Telemedicine Guidelines 2020 for psychiatrists	Privacy-by-design, consent-based reporting to institutions (as in my deck: anonymous summaries only)

9. Competitors

India

Company	What	Numbers	Vs YourDOST
Amaha (formerly InnerHour)	Therapy and psychiatry app moving into clinics and hospitals	FY25 revenue about **₹27.6 Cr** (+29%), loss about **₹29.8 Cr**; raising about ₹100 Cr (Fireside, Rainmatter, Lightbox, Alteria debt) V	Bigger revenue but loss-making and clinical; YourDOST is profitable and B2B-led
Lissun	Therapy plus child development centres	FY25 about ₹5.1 Cr (Entrackr); about $10.7M raised (Tracxn) S	Smaller; physical centres
MindPeers	Therapy plus an employee wellbeing app	FY25 about ₹4.2 Cr (Inc42) V	Smaller B2B rival
Wysa	AI chatbot plus human coaches; global (UK, US, India)	About $30M raised S	AI-first and cheap; YourDOST is human-first
1to1help, **Optum EAP**	Traditional EAP providers for corporates	Not disclosed	Direct B2B corporate rivals
Others	Mpower (Aditya Birla), Trijog, BetterLYF, Intellect (Singapore, Asia EAP), Manastha	Mostly undisclosed	Fragmented market: 262 active players, 37 funded (Tracxn)

Substitutes	Tele MANAS 14416 (free, government), peer networks, "doing nothing"	Only 15.1% seek help	The biggest competitor is not seeking help at all

Market concentration (from my deck): the four disclosed players total ₹56.8 Cr in FY25. Among them HHI is 3,720, but across a ₹150 Cr+ market it is about 530, so the market is fragmented with no clear leader.

Global

Company	Model	Numbers	Lesson for YourDOST
Lyra Health (US)	Employer-paid mental-health benefit	About $235M revenue (2024, est.); $5.6B valuation (2022) S	The B2B employer model scales; outcomes data sells
Spring Health (US)	Employer and health-plan mental health	About $281M revenue (2025, est.); $3.3B valuation (2024) S	Precision matching and measurement-based care
Headspace (merged with Ginger, 2021)	Meditation app + coaching + therapy	Private	Self-care as a funnel to coaching and therapy
BetterHelp (Teladoc), **Talkspace** (Nasdaq-listed)	Consumer and insurer online therapy	Public parents	B2C at scale needs heavy marketing; insurance coverage helps
Modern Health, **Calm**	Employer wellbeing; self-care app	Private	A tiered offer: self-care, then coaching, then therapy

10. How to pitch yourself (EIR, Founder's Office)

Say: "YourDOST has done something rare: built a profitable, debt-free mental-health business on about $1.7M of capital, with 30 lakh sessions and 500+ institutions. But revenue has been flat at about ₹20 Cr for three years. As an EIR, my job is to find and test the next growth engines. My assignment does exactly that: Q1 opens a new segment, parents, with a data-backed, calm message. Q2 attacks the utilisation problem in B2B with content that removes the 'awkward' barriers. Q3 is a new P&L, the Founders Program: a partner-led, low-CAC channel that reaches profit by Year 3 and opens team-wellness upsells. I like to do the numbers myself, ship fast, and test before scaling, like the 90-day pilot."

Questions to ask them:

- What share of revenue is corporate vs campus vs B2C today, and what is the renewal rate?
- What is the biggest constraint on growth right now: sales capacity, expert supply or utilisation?
- How are you thinking about AI, for example in intake, matching or between-session support?
- What would success look like for this role in the first 90 days?

Accuracy notes: the revenue history and FY25 profit come from MCA filings via Tracxn and Inc42. Sessions, experts, lives saved and organisation counts are YourDOST's own claims. Latka's "$32.7M revenue, $98M valuation" is an unverified estimate that conflicts with filings; don't quote it. Funding totals differ by database ($1.6–1.86M). B2B pricing is not public.

Sources: inc42.com/company/yourdost · tracxn.com (YourDost profile and legal entity) · tofler.in (Yourdost Health Solutions) · crunchbase.com · cbinsights.com · pitchbook.com · getlatka.com · yourstory.com (2015, 2016 funding, 2021 HerStory) · feminisminindia.com (2016) · entrepreneur.com (SAIF) · startupindia.gov.in · elevationcapital.com/portfolio/yourdost · tribuneindia.com (IILM) · wellness.iisc.ac.in · yourdost.com · yourdost.net · insightscare.in · Glassdoor and Indeed (YourDOST reviews and jobs) · dealroom.co and indianstartupnews.com (Amaha) · Tracxn (Lissun, MindPeers) · multiples.vc, getlatka.com (Lyra, Spring Health) · Merak Ventures State of Mind 2026 · my Q3 deck sources (Entrackr, Inc42, Lapaas Voice).